

## Interactive Entertainment Fair Standards Council Initiative

### A Public Proposal to Establish the Interactive Entertainment Fair Standards Council

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Status: Early public proposal draft. The IEFSC Initiative is not yet an incorporated organization, government body, or official standards authority. This document is a public proposal for discussion, development, and future formalization.

The video game industry has grown into one of the most influential forms of modern entertainment, commerce, social interaction, and digital culture. Games are no longer simply standalone products. They are live-service platforms, digital storefronts, online communities, competitive spaces, social ecosystems, and long-term consumer investments. As the industry has expanded, so have concerns around predatory monetization, unfair end-user license agreements, loot boxes, digital ownership, live-service shutdowns, child-targeted spending systems, publisher interference, and consumer transparency.

The current system is reactive and fragmented. Courts are often too slow and rigid to resolve industry disputes before harm occurs. Government agencies usually act only after major problems have already developed. Consumers often lack the resources, knowledge, or legal power to challenge unfair practices. Developers and smaller studios may also lack a neutral forum where concerns can be heard before conflicts become lawsuits, scandals, or public outrage campaigns.

To address this gap, this proposal recommends the creation of the Interactive Entertainment Fair Standards Council, or IEFSC.

The IEFSC Initiative is a public proposal to establish that council. The goal of the initiative is to promote fair standards, transparency, consumer protection, ethical monetization, dispute mediation, and long-term industry health across interactive entertainment.

The IEFSC is proposed as a government-chartered public-private advisory and standards body. It would not function as a censorship board, and it would not control creative content, artistic expression, game difficulty, story themes, political viewpoints, humor, genre design, or controversial ideas. Its purpose would be to focus on consumer-facing and industry-health issues where clearer standards are needed.

The IEFSC would study and provide guidance on issues such as predatory monetization, loot boxes, dark patterns, premium currencies, psychological spending pressure, child and family protections, plain-language EULA transparency, digital ownership, live-service shutdowns, refunds, preservation, consumer expectations, platform accountability, and dispute mediation between developers, publishers, platforms, and consumers.

The council could also develop voluntary certification standards for companies that meet published fair-practice guidelines. These standards would help consumers identify companies that follow clearer rules around monetization, transparency, minors' protections, digital access, and complaint resolution. Certification would not mean a company is perfect or immune from criticism; it would simply mean the company meets specific published standards.

The IEFSC should include balanced representation from government, industry, regulatory or technical experts, and ordinary consumers. A suggested structure would include public-policy members, industry members, regulatory or technical experts, and public consumer representatives from varied backgrounds. This structure would help ensure that both large companies and ordinary users have a voice in shaping standards.

The council should begin as a temporary study commission before becoming a permanent body. Its first task would be to examine whether existing consumer-protection law is sufficient for modern interactive entertainment and to recommend voluntary standards, certification programs, mediation procedures, transparency requirements, and possible legislative reforms.

The goal of the IEFSC is not to prevent companies from making money or developers from creating bold, unusual, difficult, controversial, or experimental games. Profit and creativity should remain protected. The goal is to draw a clearer line between legitimate business practices and exploitative systems that take advantage of addiction, confusion, minors, lack of transparency, or consumer powerlessness.

The interactive entertainment industry is now large enough and influential enough to require a structured public-interest forum. Without one, disputes will continue to be handled through outrage, lawsuits, corporate silence, and scattered enforcement. The IEFSC would provide a more stable middle path: flexible enough for innovation, but serious enough to protect consumers, developers, and the long-term integrity of the industry.

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